THE ONBOARDING PLAYBOOK · CASE STUDY

How I onboarded Kora Creative's whole team in 14 days. Not 90.

The exact 4-phase framework I use to take a customer from **"we just signed"** to **"we can't go back"**. Every document, email and checkpoint, shown step by step.

30-person agency | Claude rollout | First value by Day 14 | Value proven by Day 45

Amarachukwu Ozoagu
Customer Success Manager & Onboarding Lead

WHY THIS MATTERS

Most customers don't leave because the product is bad. They leave because nobody got them to value.

They sign up excited. Then they log in, see a blank screen or twenty features they don't understand, and fall into the dip. That's where you lose them.

RECAP FROM VIDEO 1 · THE CUSTOMER EMOTION JOURNEY

Where new customers churn



The dip

Every new customer feels overwhelmed in week one. Without a human, that's where they quietly churn.

"Nice to have"

If the product never reaches its first value moment, it stays optional. It's the first thing cut.

Time to Value

The single number onboarding exists to shrink. My target for Kora: 14 days.

The fix isn't more features. It's a Customer Success Manager who drives the timeline. And a framework that's the steering wheel.

THE FRAMEWORK

Four phases. One goal: get them to the first value moment fast.

1 · Handoff

Before Day 1

I know why they bought before they ever log in. They never repeat themselves.

2 · Kickoff

Days 1 to 3

We agree what success means, in their words, with baselines, owners and dates.

3 · Launch

Days 3 to 30

No blank screens. Whole team in. I watch the dip like a hawk.

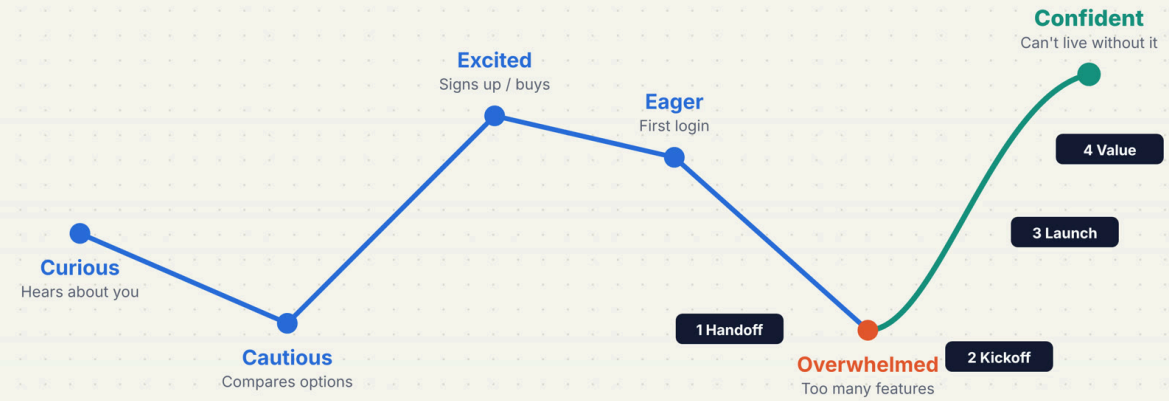
4 · Value Confirmed

Day 45

I prove the value with their own numbers, before renewal is even a question.

THE 4-PHASE ONBOARDING FRAMEWORK

The framework catches them in the dip



The dip doesn't disappear. Every new customer will feel a little overwhelmed, and that's normal. This framework catches them before they fall.

THE CUSTOMER

Meet Kora Creative.

A 30-person digital marketing agency in Manchester, UK. They just bought Claude for the whole team, on an annual plan. In a small agency's budget, that's a big line.

MEET THE CUSTOMER

Kora Creative

30-person digital marketing agency · Manchester, UK · Claude, 30 seats, annual plan with guided onboarding

Executive sponsor

James Whitaker

Managing Director. Signs the cheque.

Champion

Sophie Clarke

Operations Manager. Pushed for this.

Users

27 people

Account managers, designers, copywriters

WHAT THEY REALLY BOUGHT

"Win back our team's time without losing the Kora voice."

THE RISK

A stretched budget. It has to pay for itself by renewal.

The pain

- **3 hours per client**, every month, writing reports
- Proposals take **days**
- Half the team on personal AI accounts. One person sounds like Kora, the next "like a robot that swallowed a dictionary"

The stakes

> "This has to pay for itself by renewal."
>
> James Whitaker, Managing Director

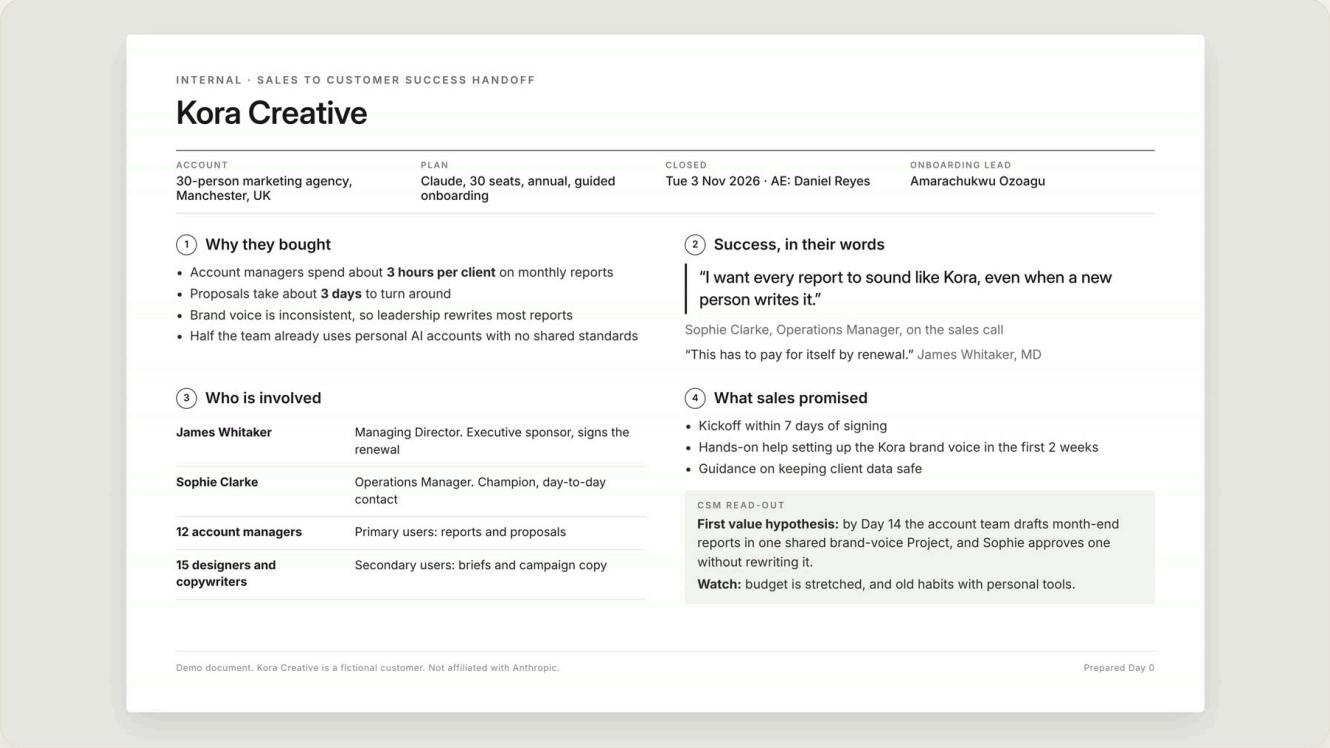
If it doesn't show value fast, it's the first thing they cut.

Kora didn't buy an AI assistant. **They bought "win back our team's time, without losing the Kora voice."** That's the job I was onboarding for.

PHASE 1 · THE HANDOFF · BEFORE DAY 1

Onboarding starts before the customer logs in.

Sales spent weeks with Kora. If that knowledge doesn't reach me, the customer starts from zero, and so does their trust. So on the day the deal closed, Daniel (sales) introduced me to Sophie, their Operations Manager, and we did a proper handoff.



INTERNAL · SALES TO CUSTOMER SUCCESS HANDOFF

Kora Creative

ACCOUNT	PLAN	CLOSED	ONBOARDING LEAD
30-person marketing agency, Manchester, UK	Claude, 30 seats, annual, guided onboarding	Tue 3 Nov 2026 · AE: Daniel Reyes	Amarachukwu Ozoagu

1 Why they bought

- Account managers spend about **3 hours per client** on monthly reports
- Proposals take about **3 days** to turn around
- Brand voice is inconsistent, so leadership rewrites most reports
- Half the team already uses personal AI accounts with no shared standards

2 Success, in their words

> "I want every report to sound like Kora, even when a new person writes it."

Sophie Clarke, Operations Manager, on the sales call

"This has to pay for itself by renewal." James Whitaker, MD

3 Who is involved

James Whitaker	Managing Director. Executive sponsor, signs the renewal
Sophie Clarke	Operations Manager. Champion, day-to-day contact
12 account managers	Primary users: reports and proposals
15 designers and copywriters	Secondary users: briefs and campaign copy

4 What sales promised

- Kickoff within 7 days of signing
- Hands-on help setting up the Kora brand voice in the first 2 weeks
- Guidance on keeping client data safe

CSM READ-OUT

First value hypothesis: by Day 14 the account team drafts month-end reports in one shared brand-voice Project, and Sophie approves one without rewriting it.

Watch: budget is stretched, and old habits with personal tools.

Demo document. Kora Creative is a fictional customer. Not affiliated with Anthropic. Prepared Day 0

The 4 questions I answer before I start. None are optional.

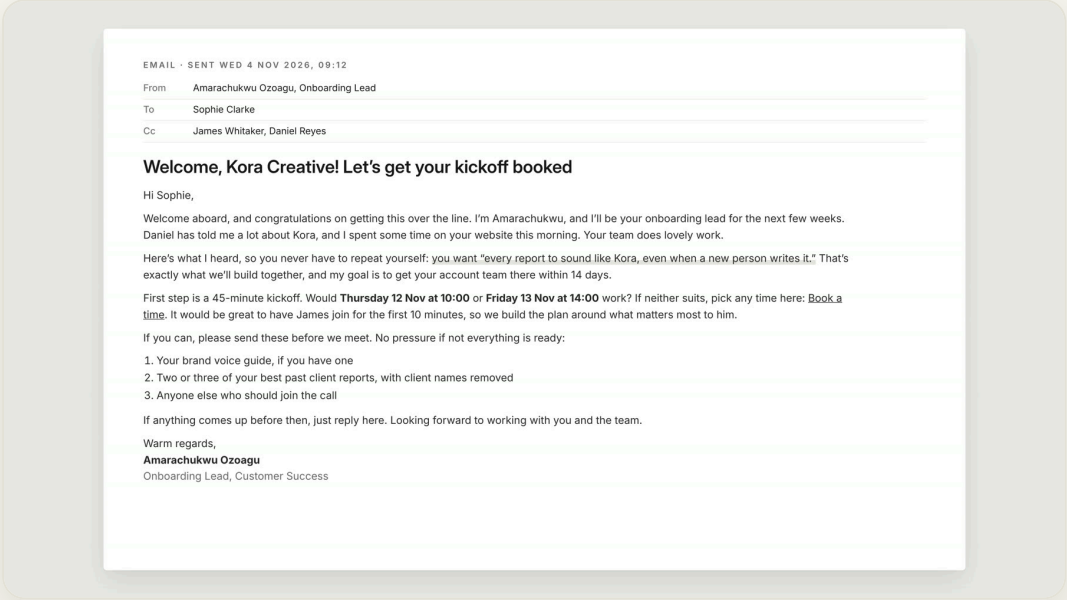
1. **Why did they buy?** 3 hours per client on reports, proposals that take days, a brand voice all over the place.
2. **Success, in their own words.** Sophie: "*I want every report to sound like Kora, even when a new person writes it.*" That sentence is gold. I use it everywhere.
3. **Who's involved?** James (MD, signs the renewal, so I need him on my side), Sophie (my champion), and 27 people who'll use it daily.
4. **What did sales promise?** Hands-on help setting up the brand voice in the first two weeks. If sales promised it, it's my job now.

Plus my first-value hypothesis: by Day 14, the account team drafts month-end reports in one shared setup, and Sophie approves one without rewriting it.

PHASE 2 · THE KICKOFF · DAYS 1 TO 3

I reach out first. Within 24 hours.

No "send me this, send me that". This is the start of a relationship.



EMAIL · SENT WED 4 NOV 2026, 09:12

From Amarachukwu Ozoagu, Onboarding Lead
To Sophie Clarke
Cc James Whitaker, Daniel Reyes

Welcome, Kora Creative! Let's get your kickoff booked

Hi Sophie,

Welcome aboard, and congratulations on getting this over the line. I'm Amarachukwu, and I'll be your onboarding lead for the next few weeks. Daniel has told me a lot about Kora, and I spent some time on your website this morning. Your team does lovely work.

Here's what I heard, so you never have to repeat yourself: you want "every report to sound like Kora, even when a new person writes it." That's exactly what we'll build together, and my goal is to get your account team there within 14 days.

First step is a 45-minute kickoff. Would **Thursday 12 Nov at 10:00** or **Friday 13 Nov at 14:00** work? If neither suits, pick any time here: Book a time. It would be great to have James join for the first 10 minutes, so we build the plan around what matters most to him.

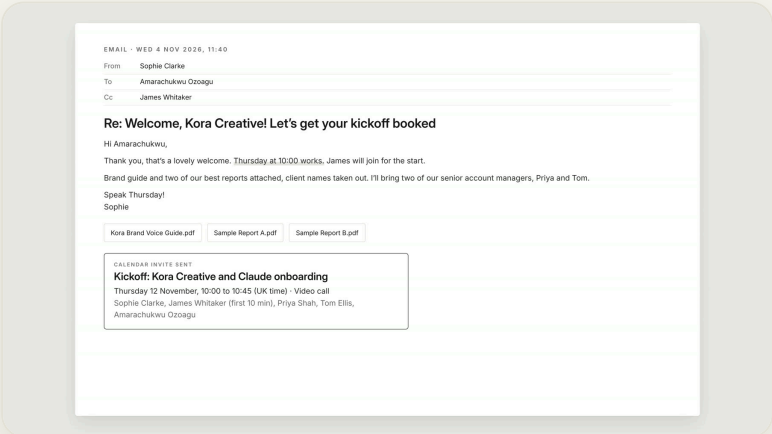
If you can, please send these before we meet. No pressure if not everything is ready:

1. Your brand voice guide, if you have one
2. Two or three of your best past client reports, with client names removed
3. Anyone else who should join the call

If anything comes up before then, just reply here. Looking forward to working with you and the team.

Warm regards,
Amarachukwu Ozoagu
Onboarding Lead, Customer Success

1. **Welcome and congratulate.** Getting a purchase approved inside a company is hard work. And I show I've looked at their work.
2. **Say back what I heard,** in her own words, so she never repeats herself.
3. **Make the next step easy:** two kickoff times or a booking link, and invite the boss for the first 10 minutes.
4. **Ask for three small things:** brand voice guide, two best reports (names removed), and who else should join.



EMAIL · WED 4 NOV 2026, 11:40

From Sophie Clarke
To Amarachukwu Ozoagu
Cc James Whitaker

Re: Welcome, Kora Creative! Let's get your kickoff booked

Hi Amarachukwu,

Thank you, that's a lovely welcome. Thursday at 10:00 works. James will join for the start.

Brand guide and two of our best reports attached, client names taken out. I'll bring two of our senior account managers, Priya and Tom.

Speak Thursday!
Sophie

Kora Brand Voice Guide.pdf | Sample Report A.pdf | Sample Report B.pdf

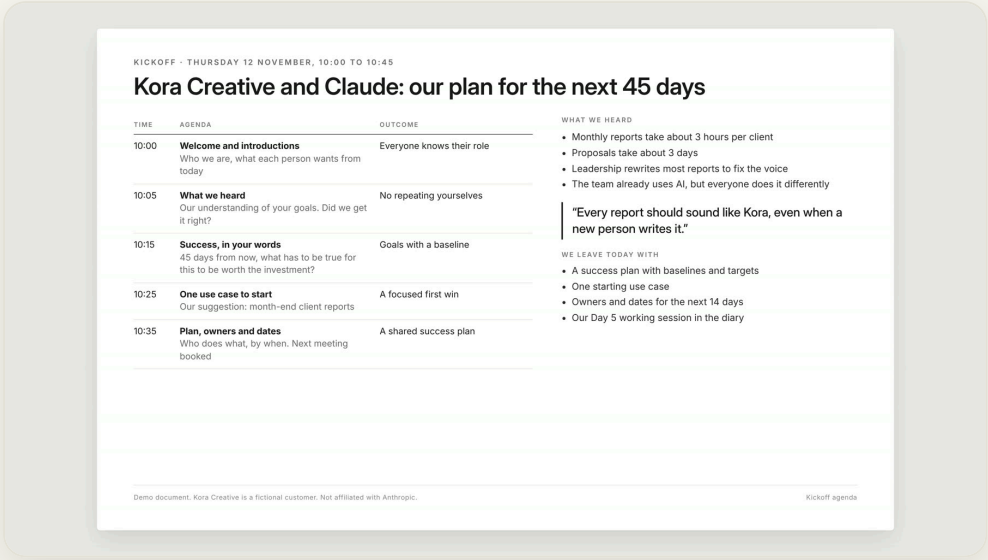
CALENDAR INVITE SENT
Kickoff: Kora Creative and Claude onboarding
Thursday 12 November, 10:00 to 10:45 (UK time) · Video call
Sophie Clarke, James Whitaker (first 10 min), Priya Shah, Tom Ellis, Amarachukwu Ozoagu

Two hours later: kickoff booked, the boss in the room, and every file I need. That's what proactive looks like.

PHASE 2 · THE KICKOFF · AGENDA & SUCCESS PLAN

The kickoff is not a product demo.

They already bought it. The kickoff has one job: **agree what success means, who's doing what, and by when.** 45 minutes, and not one minute of feature tour.



KICKOFF · THURSDAY 12 NOVEMBER, 10:00 TO 10:45

Kora Creative and Claude: our plan for the next 45 days

TIME	AGENDA	OUTCOME
10:00	**Welcome and introductions** Who we are, what each person wants from today	Everyone knows their role
10:05	**What we heard** Our understanding of your goals. Did we get it right?	No repeating yourselves
10:15	**Success, in your words** 45 days from now, what has to be true for this to be worth the investment?	Goals with a baseline
10:25	**One use case to start** Our suggestion: month-end client reports	A focused first win
10:35	**Plan, owners and dates** Who does what, by when. Next meeting booked	A shared success plan

WHAT WE HEARD

- Monthly reports take about 3 hours per client
- Proposals take about 3 days
- Leadership rewrites most reports to fix the voice
- The team already uses AI, but everyone does it differently

> "Every report should sound like Kora, even when a new person writes it."

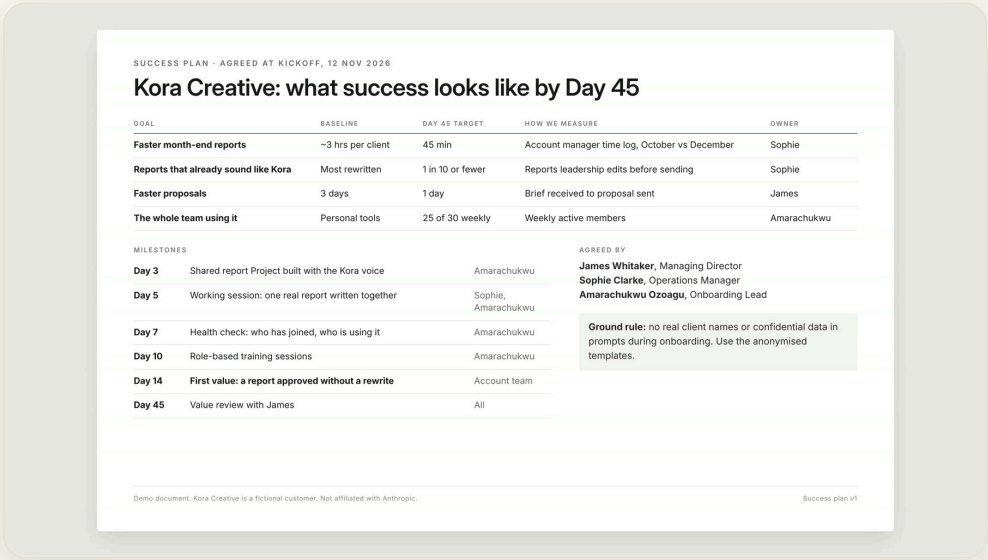
WE LEAVE TODAY WITH

- A success plan with baselines and targets
- One starting use case
- Owners and dates for the next 14 days
- Our Day 5 working session in the diary

Demo document. Kora Creative is a fictional customer. Not affiliated with Anthropic. Kickoff agenda

> **"45 days from now, what has to be true for this to be worth the money?"**
>
> The one question I ask James. His answer: "My account managers get their evenings back at month-end, and I stop rewriting reports."

Then we write it down, with baselines.



SUCCESS PLAN · AGREED AT KICKOFF, 12 NOV 2026

Kora Creative: what success looks like by Day 45

GOAL	BASELINE	DAY 45 TARGET	HOW WE MEASURE	OWNER
Faster month-end reports	~3 hrs per client	45 min	Account manager time log, October vs December	Sophie
Reports that already sound like Kora	Most rewritten	1 in 10 or fewer	Reports leadership edits before sending	Sophie
Faster proposals	3 days	1 day	Brief received to proposal sent	James
The whole team using it	Personal tools	25 of 30 weekly	Weekly active members	Amarachukwu

MILESTONES

Day 3	Shared report Project built with the Kora voice	Amarachukwu
Day 5	Working session: one real report written together	Sophie, Amarachukwu
Day 7	Health check: who has joined, who is using it	Amarachukwu
Day 10	Role-based training sessions	Amarachukwu
Day 14	**First value: a report approved without a rewrite**	Account team
Day 45	Value review with James	All

AGREED BY

James Whitaker, Managing Director
Sophie Clarke, Operations Manager
Amarachukwu Ozoagu, Onboarding Lead

Ground rule: no real client names or confidential data in prompts during onboarding. Use the anonymised templates.

Demo document. Kora Creative is a fictional customer. Not affiliated with Anthropic. Success plan v1

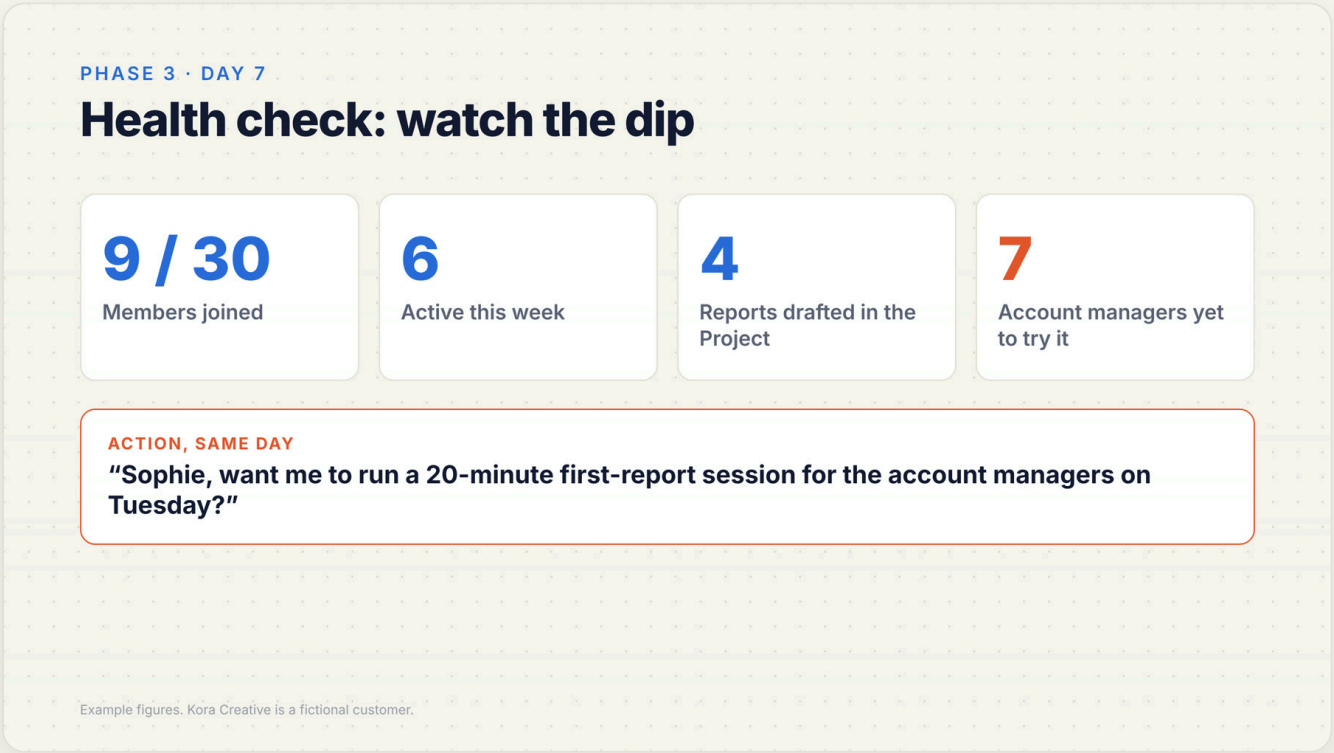
Monthly reports: **3 hours per client → 45 minutes.** Every milestone has a name and a date. James and Sophie sign it. Now we're all on the same page.

PHASE 3 · LAUNCH · DAYS 3 TO 30

The race to the first value moment.

With AI tools, the dip sounds like: "*I tried it, the answers were somehow, so I went back to doing it myself.*" So in Launch, I do three things: **no blank screens, nobody stays solo, and I watch the signals.**

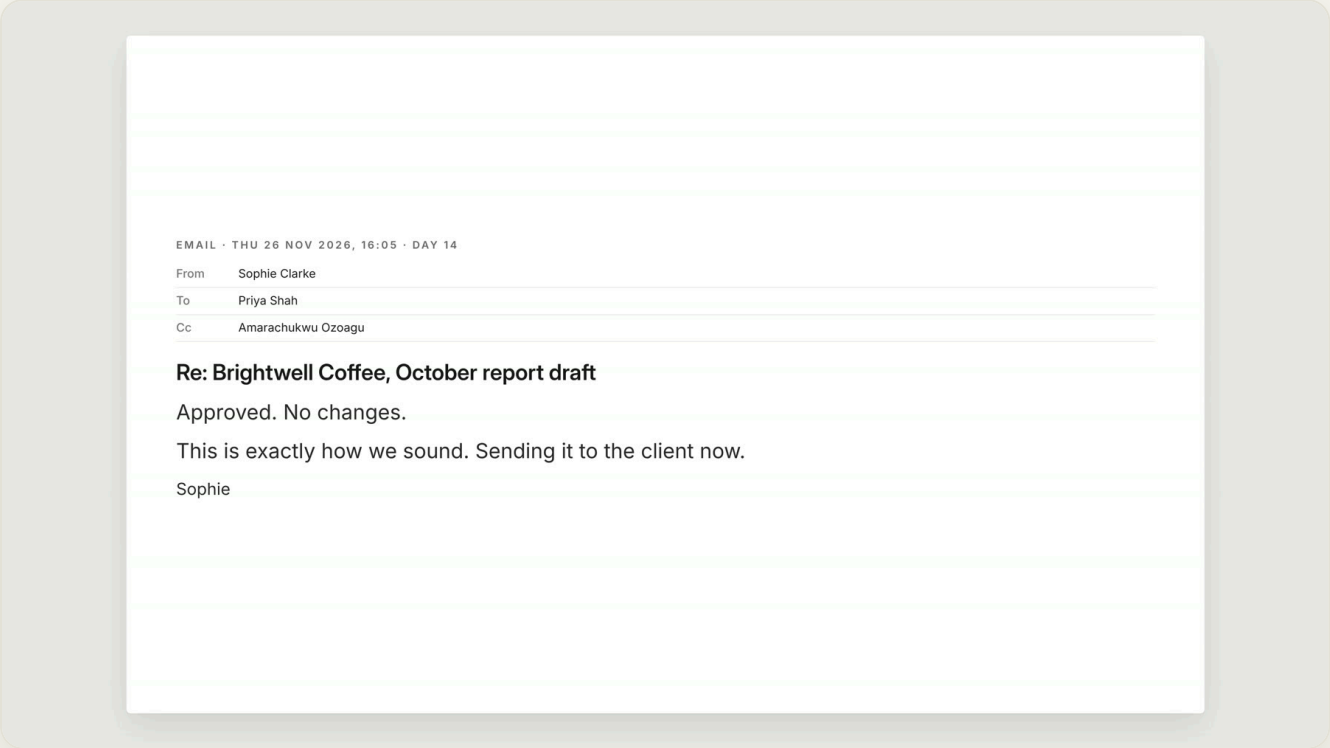
WHEN	WHAT I DO	WHY IT WORKS
Day 3	**No blank screens.** I build their Claude Project before anyone logs in: instructions written in the Kora voice (warm, plain English, British spelling, their exact report structure), plus their brand guide and two best reports uploaded.	The worst thing for a new AI user is an empty chat box.
Day 3	**Share the Project** with the whole account team.	27 people start from one setup, not 27 different prompts.
Day 5	**Working session** (not training): Sophie and I write one real report together in 30 minutes.	She sees the time saving with her own eyes.
Day 7	**Health check.** I read the signals before anyone tells me: 9 joined, 6 active, 7 account managers yet to try it. I message Sophie the same day.	In week one, a human check-in beats any feature.
Days 10–14	**Role-based training.** Account managers: month-end reports. Copywriters: campaign copy. Designers: feedback into briefs.	Nobody needs everything. Just their own thing.



PHASE 3 · DAY 14 · THE FIRST VALUE MOMENT

The day the boss stopped rewriting.

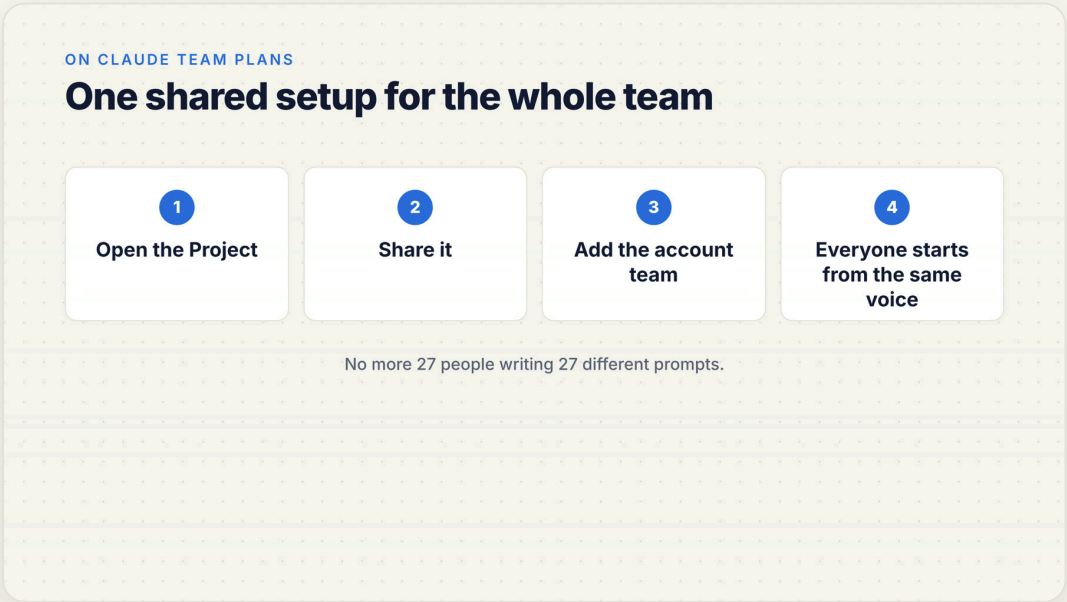
Priya drafts the Brightwell Coffee month-end report in the Project and sends it to Sophie. Sophie replies:



> **"Approved. No changes. This is exactly how we sound."**
>
> Not when they signed up. Not when they typed their first prompt. This is the moment a nice-to-have becomes a can't-live-without.

Days 15 to 30: I protect the habit.

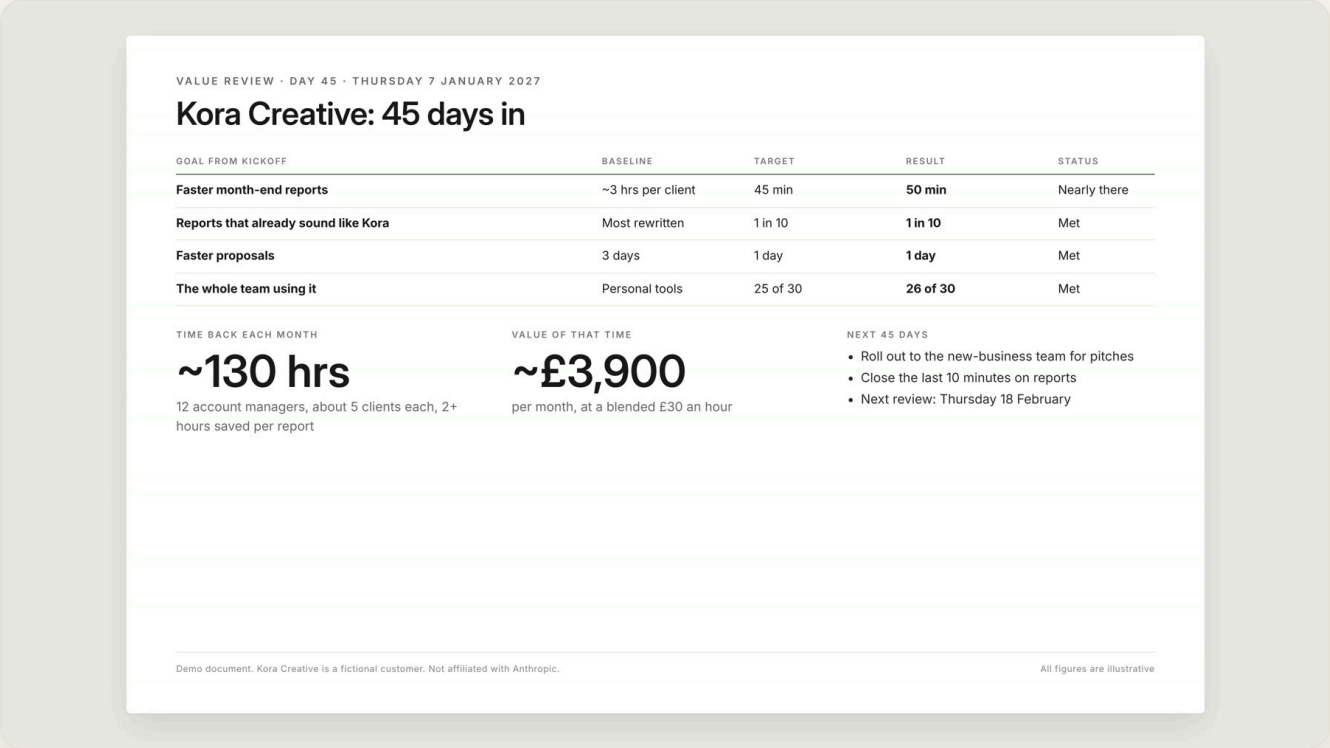
A short weekly note to Sophie: what's working, one tip, one risk. For example: "*Three account managers are still writing reports the old way. Should I send them a two-minute video?*"



PHASE 4 · VALUE CONFIRMED · DAY 45

If they don't notice the value, it doesn't exist.

Time saved is invisible. Nobody sees the three hours they didn't spend. So on Day 45, James is back in the room for 30 minutes, and I show him, against the goals we set at kickoff.



VALUE REVIEW · DAY 45 · THURSDAY 7 JANUARY 2027

Kora Creative: 45 days in

GOAL FROM KICKOFF	BASELINE	TARGET	RESULT	STATUS
Faster month-end reports	~3 hrs per client	45 min	**50 min**	Nearly there
Reports that already sound like Kora	Most rewritten	1 in 10	**1 in 10**	Met
Faster proposals	3 days	1 day	**1 day**	Met
The whole team using it	Personal tools	25 of 30	**26 of 30**	Met

TIME BACK EACH MONTH

~130 hrs

12 account managers, about 5 clients each, 2+ hours saved per report

VALUE OF THAT TIME

~£3,900

per month, at a blended £30 an hour

NEXT 45 DAYS

- Roll out to the new-business team for pitches
- Close the last 10 minutes on reports
- Next review: Thursday 18 February

Demo document. Kora Creative is a fictional customer. Not affiliated with Anthropic.

All figures are illustrative

3 of 4

goals met, one nearly there

~130 hrs

of team time back every month

~£3,900

of team time, every single month

> **"Can our new-business team use this for pitches too?"**
>
> James, when I asked my favourite question: "So, what's next for Kora?" That's expansion starting, and why Customer Success is a revenue machine.

THE PLAYBOOK ON ONE PAGE

Signed → valued → expanding. In 45 days.

PHASE	WHEN	KEY MOVE	PROOF IT WORKED
Handoff	**Before Day 1**	4-question handoff doc	Customer never repeats themselves
Kickoff	**Days 1–3**	Email in 24 h, success in their words, baselines	Signed success plan, boss in the room
Launch	**Days 3–30**	Ready-made Project, working session, Day 7 health check, role training	Day 14: "Approved. No changes."
Value Confirmed	**Day 45**	Value review with their own numbers	~130 hrs and ~£3,900 a month, expansion asked for

14 days
to first value, not 90

3h → 45m
per client report

0
"what are we even paying for?" conversations

Want this for your customers?

I'm Amarachukwu Ozoagu. I turn new sign-ups into customers who can't imagine going back. I find their aha moment, get them there fast, bring the whole team in, and catch them before the dip.

Hiring a Customer Success Manager or Onboarding Lead? Want your team trained on this framework? Find me on LinkedIn: **Amarachukwu Ozoagu**. Let's talk.

Want the templates (handoff doc, welcome email, kickoff agenda, success plan, value review)? Comment "PLAYBOOK" on the video and I'll send them to you.